

Upstander Moves



BIG IDEA When someone is being targeted, you have four safe moves. You do not have to do them all, and you never have to put yourself in danger.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Four Moves corner signs (R-7.2), Upstander Scenario Cards (R-7.1, 12 cards), pencils.

- ☐ Post the four corner signs: Say It, Stand With, Keep It, Tell It.
- ☐ Pick at least four scenario cards.
- ☐ Copy the sentence strip of upstander words.

1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script “Kenji was in a group chat when someone posted a mean joke about a classmate, Sam. Lots of kids laughed with the little laughing faces. Kenji felt his stomach drop. ‘Should I laugh? Should I say something? Should I do nothing?’ He did NOT laugh. He sent Sam a private message: ‘That was mean. I’m sorry. Want to play at recess?’ Then he told Coach Dee. That was two upstander moves. Sam said later, ‘Kenji’s message was the best part of my day.’ Bystanders are the people who see it. Upstanders do something safe. Today we learn four safe moves.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN Four Corners

- 1 (1 min) Teach the moves** with a gesture each: Say It (hand to mouth, then out), Stand With (step beside a partner), Keep It (hands close), Tell It (hand on chest, then out).
- 2 (5 min) Scenario rounds.** Read a card. Students silently pick a move and walk to that corner; one student per corner says why. No single right answer, and Tell It is always okay. At least four cards. “What would be your words?”
- 3 (2 min) Role-play one.** A student reads the card; a partner says the upstander words from the sentence strip. Applaud both.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Which move felt easiest? Which felt hardest?”
- 2** “What if you are scared of getting teased yourself?” (The other moves still help.)
- 3** “What if YOU said something mean?” (Stop, delete it, say sorry, and ask a grown-up to help fix it.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “When you see someone treated unkindly, your hackles may rise. That gut check says it is time to use a move. A false alarm is fine. Pause before you laugh or forward. Check: who is being hurt? Tell: pick a move. You never have to do it alone.”

Hand signal: The four move gestures from step 1.

EXIT TICKET “Which move would you try first, and what would you say?”

FUN BOOST Move Charades (30 seconds).

Silently act out one of the Four Moves and let the class guess it.

LEVEL-UP Upstander Streak. This week, do one Stand With move: invite someone to play or sit with you.

DIFFERENTIATE Pair students; give a sentence strip of upstander words; allow pointing to a corner.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “Which move would you try?” If your child shares that something mean happened, thank them first.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell.”
- **Do not say:** “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”
- “Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?”
- Anything beyond “Can you tell me more?”

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.